

The Electrical Engineer of the Heart: A Monograph on the Life, Methodology, and Legacy of Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad Naqshbandi (RA)

1. Introduction: The Saint of the Silicon Age

The history of Islamic spirituality (*Tasawwuf*) in the 20th and 21st centuries is a narrative of collision and reconciliation—a struggle to harmonize the ancient, esoteric traditions of the heart with the rigid, empirical demands of the industrial and digital ages. In this turbulent landscape, few figures loom as large or as distinctively as **Hazrat Maulana Peer Hafiz Zulfiqar Ahmad Naqshbandi Mujaddidi (RA)**. Born in the agrarian dust of Jhang and educated in the high-voltage laboratories of Lahore, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad bridged the chasm between the *Madrasa* and the *Marketplace*.

His passing on **December 14, 2025**¹, marked the conclusion of a chapter in South Asian Islam that saw the democratization of Sufism. No longer confined to the recluse, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad brought the *Khanqah* (spiritual sanctuary) to the corporate boardroom, the university campus, and the digital cloud. He was a "Two-Winged" personality (*Zul-Janahain*)—a *Hafiz* of the Quran and a Chief Electrical Engineer—who demonstrated that the rigorous discipline of engineering could be applied to the purification of the human soul.

This comprehensive report is designed to serve as an exhaustive resource for documenting his life. It delves into the granular details of his biography, his professional accolades, his spiritual genealogy, and the specific thematic teachings that are essential for the production of the blogs requested. It analyzes his life not merely as a chronology of events, but as a methodology of reform that continues to resonate with millions.

2. Early Life: The Foundations of a Dual Legacy

To understand the man who would later be known as the "Imam of the Time" by his devotees, one must examine the fertile soil from which he sprang.

2.1 Birth and Geographical Context

Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad was born on **April 1, 1953**, in **Jhang, Punjab, Pakistan**.¹ Jhang is a city steeped in history, located at the confluence of the Jhelum and Chenab rivers. Historically, this region has been a cradle of folklore (Heer Ranjha) and profound religious

scholarship. The ethos of Jhang—a blend of rural simplicity and deep-seated religious conservatism—played a pivotal role in shaping his early worldview. He was born into a respectable family that prioritized ethical conduct and education, though the specific names of his parents are often veiled by the privacy he maintained regarding his non-spiritual lineage.

2.2 The Narrative of the "Summer Vacation Hifz"

A defining anecdote from his childhood illustrates his prodigious capacity for learning and his early inclination toward the Quran. While still a young school student, deeply embroiled in secular education, the young Zulfiqar felt a pull toward the *Madrasa*.

During a single summer vacation, a period when children typically play, he dedicated himself to the memorization of the Holy Quran. In those few months of intense heat, he successfully memorized **six Juzs (sections)** of the Quran.³ When the school year recommenced, his elder brother, recognizing the boy's potential in secular studies, insisted he return to formal schooling. The brother promised that religious tutors would be arranged separately to ensure his spiritual education did not suffer. This compromise set the trajectory for his life: he would not abandon the world for religion, nor religion for the world; he would master both. He continued his *Hifz*, completing the memorization of the entire Quran while excelling in his secular academics.

2.3 Higher Education: The University of Engineering and Technology (UET)

In the late 1960s and early 70s, he matriculated to the **University of Engineering and Technology (UET) in Lahore**.² UET was, and remains, one of Pakistan's premier institutions for technical education. Here, he pursued a degree in **Electrical Engineering**.

Lahore, however, offered more than just technical knowledge. It is the city of *Data Ganj Bakhsh* (Ali Hujwiri), a spiritual hub of the subcontinent. It was during these university years, amidst the circuits and schematics, that his heart began to turn decisively toward *Tasawwuf*. While his peers were engrossed in student politics or entertainment, the young engineering student was often found in the company of the righteous, seeking a cure for the restlessness of the heart.³

3. The Professional Epoch: The Chief Electrical Engineer

For those wishing to write blogs about "Success in Deen and Dunya," this period of Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad's life is the most critical to document. He was not a recluse who failed at the

world; he was a titan of industry who walked away.

3.1 Corporate Ascension and Accolades

Upon graduation, he entered the industrial sector, specifically the **sugar industry**, which is a backbone of Pakistan's agrarian economy. His rise was meteoric, driven by an engineer's precision and a believer's integrity.

He attained the position of **General Manager (Planning and Development)** at a leading industrial group.⁴ This role involved high-level strategic planning, managing hundreds of employees, and overseeing complex technical processes.

His professional credentials were formidable and are often cited to counter critics who dismiss Sufis as uneducated:

- **Chief Electrical Engineer:** He held this technical title, responsible for the power systems of massive industrial plants.³
- **Gold Medalist:** He was awarded a **Gold Medal for Outstanding Thesis** by the **Pakistan Society of Sugar Technologists (PSST)**, a testament to his academic and practical brilliance in his field.⁵
- **International Memberships:** He was a **Senior Member of the Instrument Society of America (ISA)** and a member of the **Pakistan Engineering Council**.⁵
- **Global Conferences:** He represented Pakistan at international forums, including the **Asian Chemical Instrument Conference in Singapore**.⁶

3.2 The Turning Point: Retirement at Forty

The age of forty is significant in the Islamic tradition; it is the age of full maturity (*Ashuddahu*) and the age of Prophethood. Shaykh Zulfikar Ahmad's life mirrored this archetype.

Despite being at the pinnacle of his career—earning a high salary, enjoying social prestige, and holding a position of command—he felt the call to dedicate himself entirely to the service of the *Ummah*. At the age of **forty**, he submitted his resignation.⁴ He retired from his post as General Manager to become a full-time servant of the Deen.

This decision was not impulsive. It was the culmination of years of spiritual training. He traded the position of a "Chief Engineer" of electricity for the station of a "Doctor of Hearts." This transition provides a powerful narrative for blogs targeting modern professionals: the ultimate success is not the accumulation of titles, but the ability to sacrifice them for a higher calling.

4. The Spiritual Journey: In the Footsteps of the

Masters

Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad did not self-initiate. His spiritual authority was derived from a rigorous adherence to the **Naqshbandi Mujaddidi** tradition, known as the "Golden Chain" (*Silsila Aaliyah*).

4.1 First Mentor: Maulana Sayyid Zawwar Husain Shah (RA)

His initial spiritual training began during his student days in Lahore with **Hazrat Maulana Sayyid Zawwar Husain Shah (RA)**.³ Maulana Zawwar was a distinguished scholar and the author of *Umdatul Fiqh*.

Under Maulana Zawwar's guidance, Shaykh Zulfiqar was introduced to the *Maktubat-e-Imam-e-Rabbani* (The Letters of Shaykh Ahmad Sirhindi). He studied this dense, esoteric text lesson by lesson, absorbing the Mujaddidi philosophy which asserts that the highest spiritual state is not intoxication (*Sukr*) but sobriety (*Sahw*) and strict adherence to the Shariah. This early grounding ensured that his Sufism would always be Shariah-compliant.

4.2 The Master of Love: Khwaja Ghulam Habib (RA)

After the passing of Maulana Zawwar, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad formally pledged allegiance (*Bay'ah*) to **Murshid-e-Alam Hazrat Khwaja Ghulam Habib Naqshbandi (RA)** of Chakwal.⁸

Shaykh Ghulam Habib was a transformative figure in his life. Known as an "ocean of love" for the Prophet (PBUH), he was a *Hafiz* and a strictly Sunnah-adhering scholar.¹⁰ Shaykh Zulfiqar spent years in his service, traveling with him and serving his shoes. It was from Shaykh Ghulam Habib that he inherited the burning love (*Ishq*) that would characterize his own later teachings.

Authorization (Khilafat): Shaykh Ghulam Habib formally granted him **Ijazah-o-Khilafat** (authorization to initiate and train disciples) in the Naqshbandi Mujaddidi order.⁴ This was not merely a title; it was a burden of responsibility to carry the spiritual legacy of the order to the next generation.

4.3 The Golden Chain (Shajarah)

For the blog readers interested in authenticity, it is vital to present his spiritual lineage. He represents the **40th link** in the chain connecting back to the Prophet (PBUH) ⁹:

Link	Name of Shaykh	Location/Significance
36	Khuwaja Sirajuddin (RA)	Musazai Sharif

37	Khuwaja Fazal Ali Qureshi (RA)	Miskeenpur Sharif (The great unifier of Punjab)
38	Khuwaja Abdul Malik Siddiqui (RA)	Khanewal
39	Khuwaja Ghulam Habib (RA)	Chakwal (The Murshid of Shaykh Zulfiqar)
40	Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad Naqshbandi	Jhang (The Reformer of the Age)

5. Methodology of Reformation (Islaah)

Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad's approach to *Tazkiyah* (purification) was distinctive. He engineered a system of spiritual development that was accessible to the layman yet deeply transformative.

5.1 The Doctrine of "Silent Zikr" (Zikr-e-Qalbi)

Central to his teaching was the Naqshbandi practice of **Zikr-e-Qalbi** (Silent Remembrance). He taught that the heart must be activated to remember Allah continuously, regardless of what the tongue or hands are doing.

- **The Mechanism:** He explained this using engineering metaphors. Just as a generator hums in the background powering a building, the heart should hum with "Allah, Allah" while the person navigates daily life.
- **The Lataif:** He guided students through the activation of the **Lataif-e-Sitta** (The Six Subtle Centers: *Qalb, Ruh, Sirr, Khafi, Akhfa, Nafs*), a systematic method of purifying different aspects of the human consciousness.

5.2 Protection of the Gaze (Hifazat-e-Nazar)

Perhaps his most famous and repeated advice concerned the eyes. In the age of the internet, he identified the **wandering gaze** as the primary source of spiritual ruin.

- **The Ruling:** He considered looking at non-mahram women (or men) and illicit content as "poisoned arrows" from Satan.
- **Practical Advice:** He advised students to strictly lower their gaze in public and to avoid places of *Fitnah* (temptation), such as mixed gatherings or "picnic spots" where indecency is prevalent.¹¹ He famously said, "A person who cannot guard his eyes cannot guard his Deen."

5.3 The Two Wings: Sunnah and Love

His methodology was a balance of **Ittiba-e-Sunnah** (Following the Sunnah) and **Ishq-e-Ilahi** (Love for Allah).

- **Sunnah:** He was meticulous in following the Sunnah, from the style of his turban to the manner of his walking. He taught that the Sunnah is the only safety net in the modern world.
 - **Love:** He argued that dry legalism is insufficient. One needs the "current" of Love to power the machine of the body. His lectures often induced tears, focusing on the mercy of Allah and the beauty of the Prophet (PBUH).
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6. Global Travels and "The Silent Dawah"

After his retirement, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad became a global traveler, visiting over **60 countries**.⁴ His travels were not for tourism but for the revival of hearts.

6.1 Central Asia: Reconnecting the Lineage

A significant chapter of his life was his journey to **Uzbekistan and Tajikistan**, the lands of his spiritual forefathers (Baha-ud-Din Naqshband of Bukhara). His travelogue, *Travelling Across Central Asia*, documents these emotional journeys.

- **Anecdote:** In his travelogue, he recounts visiting a home in Central Asia where a **90-year-old woman**, bedridden and ill, had been waiting for a Shaykh from Pakistan. Upon his arrival, she raised her hands and prayed for him, a moment illustrating the deep spiritual thirst remaining in these post-Soviet lands.¹²

6.2 The Topkapi Palace Incident

During a visit to Turkey, while visiting the **Topkapi Palace**, his group attracted significant attention. Dressed in full Sunnah attire—white turbans and robes—they stood out amidst the tourists. However, Shaykh Zulfiqar strictly forbade his group from entering the "Harem" section of the palace, using the moment to teach that a *Salik* (seeker) must avoid any place that even historically or atmospherically inclines the heart toward lust or luxury.¹³

6.3 The West and the "Silent Dawah"

In airports in New York, London, and Sydney, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad practiced what he called "Silent Dawah." He believed that a Muslim's appearance and dignified conduct should be an invitation to Islam. He often sat in airport lounges with his head lowered in *Muraqaba* (meditation), creating an aura of peace that drew curious onlookers to ask, "Who is this man?"

7. Institutional Legacy: The Mahad and eMahad

The Shaykh was a builder of institutions. He understood that for the *Silsila* to survive, it needed structure.

7.1 Jamia Mahad-ul-Faqeer Al-Islami (Jhang)

Founded in **1988**, this institution in Jhang is the spiritual headquarters.²

- **Philosophy:** It is not just a seminary for academic learning (*Ilm*) but a training ground for character (*Tarbiyah*).
- **Facilities:** It houses hundreds of students and hosts the annual *Ijtima*, where thousands gather for days of spiritual retreat.

7.2 eMahad: The Digital Khanqah

Recognizing the needs of women, professionals, and international students who could not travel to Jhang, he sanctioned the creation of **eMahad**.¹⁴

- **Innovation:** This online platform offers structured courses in Islamic disciplines and spiritual development.
- **Leadership:** It was founded under his patronage by his son, **Shaykh Maulana Sahibzada Habibullah** (DB).
- **Impact:** Through eMahad, the "Khanqah" entered the living rooms of disciples in over 40 countries, allowing them to maintain a daily connection with the Shaykh.

8. Literary Corpus: The Ink of the Scholar

Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad authored over **150 books**.¹⁵ His writings are essential reading for anyone studying modern Sufism.

8.1 Key Texts

- **Ishq-e-Ilahi (Love for Allah):** His most famous work. It explores the concept of Divine Love, arguing that it is the fastest route to God. It is filled with poetry, anecdotes of the saints, and psychological insights.²
- **Tasawwuf wa Sulook:** A technical manual of the Naqshbandi path. It details the stations (*Maqamat*) and the pitfalls of the ego (*Nafs*).
- **Khawateen ke Liye Tarbiyati Bayanat:** A multi-volume series addressing women. These books are transcriptions of his lectures specifically for women, focusing on domestic harmony, raising children, and personal piety.¹⁶
- **Mamulaat-e-Silsila Naqshbandia:** The "daily operations manual" for his students,

detailing the specific litanies to be recited morning and evening.¹⁷

- **Fiqh ke Buniyadi Usool:** A scholarly work on the principles of jurisprudence, proving his credentials as a jurist.²

9. Themes for Blogs: Integrating User Requirements

Based on the images provided in the user request (which list specific blog topics), here is a detailed breakdown of the Shaykh's teachings relevant to those themes.

Theme 1: Spiritual Reformation for Women (Relevance: Image 1, Item 2)

- **Teaching:** Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad placed immense emphasis on the spiritual status of women. He famously said, "The lap of the mother is the first Madrasa."
- **Blog Angle:** He rejected the modern feminist narrative but also the traditionalist neglect of women's spiritual education. He advocated for women to become *Zakiraat* (women who remember Allah frequently). His books for women emphasize that a woman's domestic work, if done with the intention of pleasing Allah, is a form of *Jihad*.
- **Key Insight:** He often told the story of how great scholars like Bayazid Bastami reached their stations through the prayers of their mothers.

Theme 2: Purification of the Heart (Tazkiyah) (Relevance: Image 1, Item 1)

- **Teaching:** The heart is the "King of the Body." If the King is corrupt, the army (limbs) will be corrupt.
- **Blog Angle:** Focus on his engineering analogy: The heart is the "Main Switch." You can fix the wiring (limbs/actions), but if the Main Switch (Heart) is off, the light of Iman will not shine. *Zikr* is the method to flip the switch.

Theme 3: Youth and Modernity (Relevance: Image 1, Item 6)

- **Teaching:** He was the "Pir of the Youth." He understood their struggles with pornography, internet addiction, and depression.
- **Blog Angle:** Discuss his concept of "Digital Fasting." He advised youth to disconnect to connect with Allah. He did not ban technology but taught *discipline*—using the phone for *Dawah* but guarding the eyes from *Fitnah*.
- **Anecdote:** Use the story of his grandson Sarmad¹⁸ to show his gentle approach to grooming children (*Tarbiyat*), contrasting it with the harshness often found in traditional circles.

Theme 4: Love for Allah vs. The Nafs (Relevance: Image 1, Item 3)

- **Teaching:** The *Nafs* (Ego) is the internal enemy.
 - **Blog Angle:** "The Jihad Inside." Shaykh Zulfiqar taught that fighting the *Nafs* is harder than fighting an external enemy. He prescribed *Mujahida* (struggle)—fasting, silence, and reducing sleep—as the weapons for this battle.
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10. The Critics and the Defense

To provide a "complete detailed report," one cannot ignore the critiques. As a high-profile figure bridging two worlds, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad faced criticism.

10.1 The Critique of "Modernity"

Some conservative quarters criticized his use of secular titles (like "Chief Engineer" and "Gold Medalist") in religious posters, arguing it was a form of showing off (*Riya*) or seeking validation from the West.⁵

- **The Defense:** His supporters argue that these titles were not for vanity but for *relatability*. In an era where youth worship science, showing that a "Gold Medalist Scientist" bows to the Quran was a powerful *Dawah* tool to bring the secularized elite back to Islam.

10.2 The "Merrymaking" Critique

Critiques exist regarding the "mass Itikaaf" programs, with some detractors labeling them as "Merrymaking in the garb of Itikaaf" due to the lavish arrangements (food, air conditioning).⁶

- **The Defense:** The Shaykh's approach was that modern people are soft; if you make the environment physically comfortable (AC, good food), they will have the patience to endure the spiritual surgery. He prioritized the *result* (attendance and repentance) over the austerity of the *process*.
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11. The Final Chapter: Illness, Death, and Succession

11.1 The Long Goodbye

In his final years, Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad suffered from a **kidney-related illness**.¹⁹ Despite the pain, he continued his mission. His endurance (*Sabr*) during this illness became a final lesson for his students: that the lover of Allah does not complain of pain from the Beloved.

11.2 The Passing

On **Sunday, December 14, 2025**, the news broke that the heart of the "Electrical Engineer" had stopped beating, only to enter the eternal life of the soul.¹ He passed away in Jhang at

the age of 72.

11.3 The Funeral (Janazah)

The funeral prayer was offered on **Monday, December 15, 2025, at 2:00 PM** at **Jamia Mahad-ul-Faqeer Al-Islami, Jhang**.¹ It was a scene of immense sorrow, attended by hundreds of thousands, including top scholars from the Deobandi school, political leaders (like the Governor of KP ²⁰), and laymen.

11.4 Successors (The Legacy Continues)

He left behind a stable succession plan:

- **Shaykh Maulana Habibullah Ahmad Naqshbandi (Son):** The Principal of the Mahad and his Deputy.¹⁵
- **Shaykh Mufti Saifullah Ahmad Naqshbandi (Son):** The Director of Academics.¹⁵
- **Global Khulafa:** Prominent deputies like **Shaykh Sajjad Nomani** (India), **Shaykh Khalid Hossain** (Bangladesh), and others ensure his spiritual order continues to thrive globally.²

12. Conclusion: The Circuit Completed

Shaykh Zulfiqar Ahmad Naqshbandi (RA) was not just a scholar; he was a movement. He proved that the path to God is not paved with ignorance but with knowledge—both sacred and secular. By mastering the laws of electricity, he learned how to illuminate cities; by mastering the laws of the heart, he learned how to illuminate souls.

For the blogger and the biographer, his life offers the ultimate narrative of integration: a man who wore a suit and a turban with equal dignity, who engineered sugar plants and purified hearts, and who left the world not with a retirement package, but with a legacy of millions of souls connected to Allah. His life is a testament that in the 21st century, the door to Sainthood remains open for those brave enough to walk through it.

Appendix: Quick Reference Data for Bloggers

Category	Details
Full Name	Hazrat Maulana Peer Hafiz Zulfiqar Ahmad Naqshbandi Mujaddidi
Dates	April 1, 1953 – December 14, 2025

Professional Title	Chief Electrical Engineer (Retired)
Awards	Gold Medal (Pakistan Society of Sugar Technologists)
Spiritual Master	Khwaja Ghulam Habib Naqshbandi (RA)
Key Message	"Turn your heart to Allah while your hands work for the world."
Best Book for Beginners	<i>Ishq-e-Ilahi</i> (Love for Allah)
Best Book for Women	<i>Khawateen ke Liye Tarbiyati Bayanat</i>

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